

What is Qalqalah?

Qalqalah (meaning: trembling/shaking) is a small bounce or echo sound that appears on 5 specific letters when they have Sukoon (no vowel). It sounds like a tiny 'ah' that wasn't there — a slight rebound after the letter.

The 5 Qalqalah Letters

Mnemonic: Qutbu Jad (meaning: pole of grandfather)

Letter	Name	Sound	Example Word
Qaaf (q)	Strong Q from back throat	Emphatic, from uvula	Aqrab (closer)
Taa (t emphatic)	Heavy T (not ta)	Tongue presses roof firmly	Ittaqoo (fear Allah)
Ba (b)	Lip letter	Both lips explosive release	Rabb (Lord)
Jeem (j)	Mid-mouth J	Tongue mid-palate	Ajr (reward)
Daal (d)	Regular D	Tongue behind upper teeth	Ahad (One)

3 Strengths of Qalqalah

Strength	When	Bounce Amount	Example
Weak	Letter has Sukoon mid-word	Very slight bounce	Yakhlukukum — Qaaf in middle
Medium	Letter at end of word, regular stop	Clear bounce	Qul (Say!) — Laam has sukoon, slight
Strong	Letter has Shadda AND you stop	Maximum bounce	Wa-Tabb (Surah Al-Masad) — Ba with Shadda at stop

When Qalqalah Does NOT Apply

- When the Qalqalah letter has a VOWEL (fatha, damma, kasra) — no bounce
- When you are not stopping on it (and it's mid-word with a vowel) — no bounce

Practice in Al-Fatiha & Short Surahs

- ★ Al-Ikhlās: Ahaḍ (One) — Daal at the end = medium Qalqalah bounce on stop
- ★ Al-Masad: Wa-Ṭabb — Ba with Shadda at end = STRONGEST Qalqalah
- ★ Al-Falaq: Al-Falaq — Qaaf at the end has bounce on stop
- ★ Practice: stop on the word and listen to the natural bounce — don't add a full vowel, just a slight echo.